



Manned-unmanned teaming demonstration by Airbus (Credit: www.airbus.com)

growing pace. Commercial adoption and technological advancements are pushing the entire industry forward. Every aspect from core technology to the fundamentals of certification and safety are under consideration. National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) is working to improve hyper-spectral communications, networking and air traffic control for efficient and safe future flights.

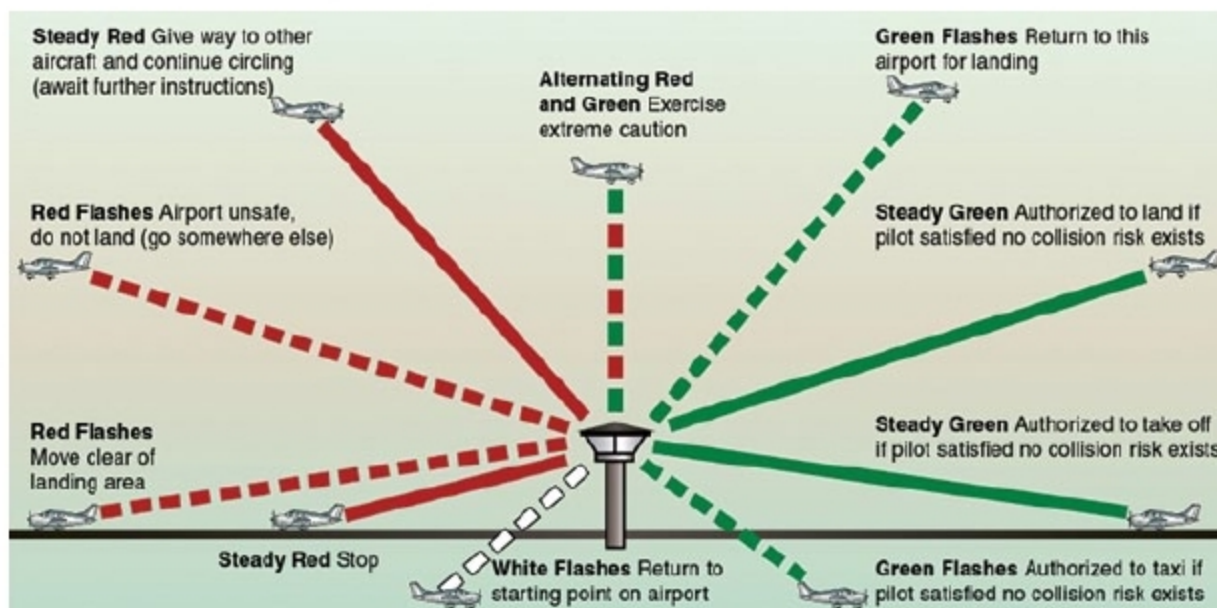
Earle Olson, vice president, Airborne Wireless Network, says, "Wireless communication for aviation, traditionally, has been relegated to weather and flight information. Beyond this, there have been additional applications related to in-flight entertainment. This area has been supported by ground-to-air and sat-com applications as well as wireless access points onboard aircraft."

He adds, "Airborne Wireless Network is developing a high-perfor-

mance communications system to provide a whole-sale airborne wireless broadband service to provide service on a global basis, utilising commercial aircraft as part of its global airborne mesh network. This is a path-breaking technology that has the potential to augment connectivity to the underserved regions of the world and improve connectivity for all. By virtue of the system being onboard commercial aircraft, its system could also support in-flight entertainment companies with a provision and drastically improve the Wi-Fi provider's service quality and overall passenger experience."

In aircraft, various parts are designed just to keep track of its location and broadcast it. The black box, fitted with an underwater locator, records flight data and communications within the cockpit. GPS allows pilots to navigate and determine where they are. Transponders transmit signals to be picked up by radars. Aircraft communications addressing and reporting system allows pilots to send short text messages transmitted through radio signals and satellites to ground control.

There are two types of radars: primary and secondary. Primary radars



Symbols from air traffic control (Credit: http://airsoc.com)

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